The Tall Marker

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 7

Nib recorded the top of the tall marker as the water level. It made the channel seem impressively full. Lark crouched beside the real water-line notch near its base. The label described a tall post; it did not say the water reached its top.

“A remarkably tall amount of water,” Nib announced. “A remarkably tall post,” Lark corrected kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **table**

“In all, tall, and ball, a has the vowel sound we are explicitly modeling here,” Lark explained clearly. “It isn't the short a of mat. Read the examples, then keep the word's meaning separate from the measurement we take beside the object.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try all, tall, ball. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tall on the comparison card,” Lark invited gently. “Which actual notch shows where the water reaches?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The post is tall. The notch is low.**

“Does tall describe the post or the notch?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes the notch?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib lowered his pencil to the observed water line. The reading was low, matching the earlier view of weak flow at the inlet. Lark crossed out the mistaken post-top measurement with a single line so the revision stayed visible. The access cover already found at the inlet was their next inspection point.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write tall beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal distinguished the marker's height from the water's level. The crew had a stronger question about the inlet, without pretending that one low reading already named its cause.